Elysium — Playtest Guide

Build **9d76b51e** · 26 September 2026 · elysium-all-1.0.0.jar + elysiumcolonies-1.0.0.jar

This covers what is in the jar installed in **Instances/Claude** and **Instances/Claude-dev-build** right now. It is written to be held while playing: each section says what the thing is, the one property it is supposed to have, how to put that property under pressure, and what would count as it being broken.

Every table below is read out of the rules files the build was compiled from, so the guide is wrong only if the tree is. The prose is written; the numbers are not.

Read this first: every creature has a new name

134 of the 176 creature ids in **elysium-bestiary** were taken verbatim from the jars they were converted from — 58 from born_in_chaos, 28 from Valoria, 27 from fangs_n_claws, 13 from knightquest, 10 from friendsandfoes. That was a defect rather than a naming choice, and the whole roster has been re-themed: a scorpion family is now `ferricbarb, dunebarb, rimebarb, cinderbarb`, and a court reads `forgeprime, forgecaller, forgeguard`. **Every entity id in this build is different from the last one**, so a world saved against the previous jar will not find its mobs. Use a fresh world. `check_names.py` is the rule that now holds it, and `docs/NAMING.md` is why.

The commands you will want

`/gamerule doDaylightCycle false`	freeze the clock for the light tests
`/summon elysiumbestiary:<id> ~ ~ ~`	every creature in this guide
`/give @s elysiumcomforts:<id>`	every fitting and comfort
`/give @s elysiumarcana:<id>`	geodes, budding blocks and relics
`/execute in elysiumwilds:vale run tp @s ~ 100 ~`	into the Vale
`/locate biome elysiumwilds:vale_<crossing>`	find a named crossing
`/data get entity @e[limit=1,sort=nearest] Health`	read a real number off a mob

1. The Vale

28 creatures across 15 crossings of the `elysiumwilds:vale` dimension, in four rings.

The claim. Which direction you walk out of the portal is not a difficulty setting. The fifteen crossings are read as four rings out from whichever one a portal drops you nearest; each ring owns a band of danger; the bands tile and rise and do not overlap; and every crossing has something in it. A dimension where the hardest thing can stand next to the portal is one where exploring is a coin flip — the player who walked north calls it unfair and the player who walked south calls it empty, and both are describing the same build.

The bands

Danger is `health x (1 + damage) x speed / 0.25`. Each ring owns a slice of it and every creature in that ring must land inside its own slice.

Ring	Danger band	Crossings	Creatures
0	20 to 80	1	2
1	80 to 200	4	7
2	200 to 500	6	11
3	500 to 1100	4	8

Every crossing, by ring

Ring	Crossing	What lives there	Danger
0	verdant_vale	verdlet, verdmote	43-50
1	bloomfen	bloomkin, bloomcrawler	115-130
1	chalk_downs	chalkin, chalkcrawler	135-143
1	goldwood	goldkin	168-168
1	pinewold	pinekin, pinecrawler	104-133
2	amber_scrub	amberhulk, ambermaw	269-307
2	ashen_steppe	ashulk, ashmaw	250-343
2	coldmarsh	marshulk, marshmaw	265-358
2	emberwood	emberhulk, embermaw	330-442
2	glacier_vale	glacehulk	370-370
2	reedbasin	reedhulk, reedmaw	306-403
3	cinder_flats	cinderprime, cinderwarden	617-857
3	frostmere	frostprime, frostwarden	619-962
3	rime_barrens	rimeprime, rimewarden	612-726
3	sulphur_springs	sulphprime, sulphwarden	649-876

What to check

1. Go through the portal, note which crossing you land nearest, and walk outward. Danger should rise and keep rising. Walk back in and it should fall. If you can find a route where a ring 3 creature is the first thing you meet, the ring arithmetic is wrong and that is the single most important bug in this feature.

2. Visit all fifteen crossings with `/locate biome`. Every one should have something in it. An empty crossing reads to a player as a bug in worldgen and is actually a missing spawn rule.

3. Spawn one of each in a flat world and compare how long each takes to kill you against the table. A creature that feels wildly out of place for its ring is worth reporting even if the number says it is fine — the number is a proxy and the proxy may be the thing that is wrong.

Known-good: ring 0 is one crossing, `verdant_vale`, and holds the two weakest things in the dimension. If the portal never seems to land near it, say so — that is a worldgen question rather than a bestiary one.

2. Lighting a room

30 fittings in six kinds, in **elysium-comforts**. The newest thing in the build and the one most worth an hour.

The claim. This is the conversion failure that leaves no trace. A decoration pack adds thirty light sources; each is prettier than a torch, most are cheaper, several are brighter, and every one of them is defensible on its own. Nobody decides that light should stop being a resource. It stops being one as the sum of thirty decisions that were each about how a room looks — and the bestiary's haunts each name a band of light they spawn in, almost all of them dark. A bright, cheap decoration roster does not make those creatures rarer. It makes them impossible anywhere anybody has decorated.

So the number this module is held to is not its own. **STILL_DARK is 7**, because 7 is the brightest light at which a majority of the bestiary's nine monsters still spawn: five of nine at seven, two of nine at eight. Nothing here reaches light 14, which is one under the game's own.

The roster

Kind	How many	Light	Cost (items)
candle_holder	21	4-12	2-7
doormat	1	0-0	2-2
fire_pit	1	11-11	5-5
lamp	4	13-14	8-9
lantern	2	9-12	4-6
rope	1	0-0	1-1

The sixteen dyed candle holders are built in a loop, so they are one light level and one price by construction. Colour is not a stat.

What to check

1. The one that matters. Build a sealed room, light it *only* with candle holders, and stand in it at night with `/gamerule doDaylightCycle false`. Monsters should still spawn. A room a player has decorated is not supposed to be safe. If it goes quiet, the cross-module claim has failed in the game even though it passes in the validator, and that is the most valuable thing you can find this pass.

2. Light the same room with lamps instead. It should go quiet. Lamps are the expensive, bright answer and they are supposed to work.

3. Craft one of each. The item count in the recipe should equal the cost in the table above. Anything that costs more or less than its row is a bug in the generator, not in the rules.

4. Check the doormat and the rope give no light at all, and that you can walk over the doormat without stepping up.

5. There should be exactly one rope in the creative tab. The module already had one for hammocks; if there are two, the rule that was written to prevent precisely that has failed.

3. Seeding a budding block

30 materials in **elysium-arcana**. Replaces GeOre, which is now retired to mods/_superseded in both instances.

The claim. A geode system where the only way to get a budding block is to find one is a system most players never touch. Seeding is the other end — but a seeding is a *multiplier* on something you already have, never a *source* of something you have not. Every material is paid for in its own blocks, so you need platinum to farm platinum and where the first platinum came from is still the foundry's problem. Anything else and every ore in the pack is obtainable from whichever one is cheapest.

A cluster gives 4. Every seeding pays for itself in between 2 and 10 cluster cycles: under that it is free and finding a geode stops being worth anything, over it nobody ever does it and the recipe is a line in a book.

A sample of the ladder

Material	Paid in	Shards	Blocks in the recipe	Catalyst
coal	coal	8	2	glow ink sac
redstone	redstone	8	2	glow ink sac
amethyst	amethyst	8	2	glow ink sac
emerald	emerald	12	3	glow ink sac
diamond	diamond	16	4	glow ink sac
iron	iron	20	5	echo shard
gold	gold	24	6	echo shard
platinum	platinum	32	8	echo shard
uranium	uranium	32	8	echo shard
bort	bort	32	8	echo shard

What to check

1. Craft a budding block for something cheap (coal) and something dear. The recipe should be that material's own blocks plus one catalyst, and nothing else. A recipe that takes somebody else's blocks is the failure this whole feature is built to avoid.

2. Place one, let it grow, and count the cycles until it has paid back what it cost. It should land between two and ten.

3. Break a seeded block. It should drop itself. If it drops its shards instead, breaking and replacing becomes a loop.

4. GeOre is gone. Check nothing in the pack still points at a geore: item — the oritech compat recipes it was blocked on were the reason it stayed so long. A recipe book entry that cannot be crafted is the symptom.

4. The rest of the bestiary

Shipped earlier this run, and worth a pass because the Vale and the lighting both lean on them.

The courts — 58 creatures in 8 courts

The bestiary's nine beasts are a ladder with no boss tier at all, so this is the row that decides what a boss is here. Three numbers rather than prose: a head may be three times the beast of its own rung; a court's threat is held *under* its head's, with the budget divided among its members, so adding to a court makes every member weaker; and a second phase must change what the player does rather than carry more health.

Court	Members	Roles present
breach	9	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HEALER, HERALD, MOUNT, SHIELD, SWARM
brood	10	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HERALD, SHIELD, SWARM
forge	9	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HERALD, SHIELD, SWARM
graft	13	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HEALER, HERALD, MOUNT, SHIELD, SWARM
hoar	2	HEAD, SWARM
pack	2	HEAD, SWARM
rot	6	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HERALD, SHIELD, SWARM
static	7	ARTILLERY, HEAD, HEALER, HERALD, SWARM

Check: fight a head to half health and watch the phase flip. It is a synched boolean on one entity, not a second entity — if the boss vanishes and a new one appears, loot and aggro will both be wrong.

The warded — 13 creatures over six wards

knightquest is 173 items of gear with a roster attached, so its creatures are the ones that exist to be fought *with* something. That fails two ways and both look like content: too far one way the creature is a door and the player who has the set never learns there was a fight; too far the other the gear is a texture with a tooltip and nobody complains, they just stop wearing it.

Ward	Creatures	What answers it
BLAST	2	iron chestplate, netherite ingot
CURSE	2	golden apple, totem of undying
FLAME	3	magma cream, potion, water bucket
FROST	1	leather boots
ROT	3	golden carrot, honey bottle, milk bucket
SHOT	2	shield, turtle helmet

Check: fight one warded creature with the answer and once without. Both should be a fight. The attack number on the entity is the *unwarded* one, so if it hits equally hard either way the ward is not being applied.

The kindred — 27 creatures in 13 families

A roster grows by variant because variants are cheap: one scorpion becomes four, the count goes up by three and the number of fights goes up by none. Three rules make a family a promise — no two of a family do the same thing, no two live in the same place, and a variant is not a harder version, because harder is what tier is for.

Check: meet two of one family and confirm they fight differently. If a frost scorpion is a desert scorpion with more health, the feature has not landed however well the validator passes.

The companions — 11, one job each

A block sits there. That is the whole of what a block has over something alive: it needs no feeding, it does not wander off, and it does not have to be found and earned first. A creature that does a block's job for free makes the block stop being built, quietly, one category at a time. Each companion does exactly one thing a block does, and every one is tamed, or fed, or has to be kept close.

Check: confirm each has an upkeep you actually feel. A companion you can set down and forget is a block with legs.

The farm — 9 machines

A mob farm is a multiplier on reward-per-danger, and a multiplier can break the bestiary's spread without touching a line of it — the bestiary's own proof would still pass. The finding that made this a check rather than a comment: a killer that takes the player's kill credit, with orbs left at zero, moves the spread from 1.148 to 1.618 and quietly changes what the best thing in the pack to farm is.

Check: build a farm from the machines and confirm experience still arrives when the machine lands the kill. Then confirm it is worse than killing by hand, because that is the whole point.

5. Comforts and arcana, in brief

Shipped before this run. Worth a quick pass to confirm nothing regressed when the lighting and the seeding went in.

The grave

Nothing you owned is ever lost. The grave is built around what it is handed rather than given a fixed size, which is how every gravestone mod that ever ate somebody's backpack did it. Check: die holding a full inventory and a full backpack, and count what comes back.

Somewhere to sleep

33 blocks: a sleeping bag and a hammock in sixteen colours each, plus the rope. A bag is for the night and a hammock for the day, with no hour that is both and no gap between them. Neither moves your spawn. Check: try to sleep in each at the wrong hour and read the refusal — there are six of them and each has its own sentence.

The chimes

96 chimes over six materials and sixteen colours, each ringing at a note of its own. Check: hang twenty in one room. It must be no louder than one of them, or a decoration becomes a weapon against the person who built it.

The stations

Eight blocks, each doing one thing a player would otherwise do by hand. None is better value than a pair of hands and none is quicker. Check: time one against doing it yourself.

The post

Eleven pigeonholes, eight kinds of mail, two birds. A parcel is never in two places and never in none, and a seal only opens in the hands it is addressed to. Check: post something to yourself, then to a second player, and try to open theirs.

The geodes and the relics

30 materials with a whole growth chain each, and 30 relics across eight slots carrying the shared ability system. Check: a relic's ability should be the same ability the arsenal's uniques use — if they diverge, the shared library has been forked by accident.

6. The checklist

Tick as you go. The middle column is what you would see if it is right.

Done	Check	What right looks like
	Vale: danger rises walking out from the portal	harder every ring
	Vale: all 15 crossings have something in them	nothing empty
	Lighting: candle-lit room still spawns monsters	not safe
	Lighting: lamp-lit room goes quiet	safe, and dear
	Lighting: recipes cost what the table says	item count matches
	Lighting: exactly one rope in the creative tab	one
	Seeding: recipe is own blocks plus a catalyst	nothing borrowed
	Seeding: pays back in 2 to 10 cycles	inside the band
	Seeding: a seeded block drops itself	no loop
	GeOre: nothing points at a geore: item	no dead recipes
	Courts: phase flip is one entity, not two	same mob, new fight
	Warded: a fight with the gear and without	both a fight
	Kindred: two of a family fight differently	not a reskin
	Companions: upkeep is felt	not a block with legs

Done	Check	What right looks like
	Farm: machine kills still give experience	orbs arrive
	Farm: worse than killing by hand	hand wins
	Grave: full inventory comes back whole	nothing missing
	Chimes: twenty are no louder than one	no wall of sound
	Post: a sealed parcel will not open in the wrong hands	refused

How to report something

What you did, what you saw, what you expected. If it is a number, the number. If it is a creature, its id from `/data get entity` rather than its display name, because the display names are the half that is about to change. A bug in a rule is worth more than a bug in a texture, and a rule that passes in the validator and fails in the game is worth more than both.